



Image Ashish Tripathy, Chennai

Each month *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 20th of this month.

Beat That!

Digit Caption

"Quantum leap—from lap to desk!"

Last Month's Winner!

Ratish K P

Hyderabad

"CPU: Cool Paan Unit!"



E-mail your caption with the subject "Beat That", and your postal address, to beatthat@thinkdigit.com

and win

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varying authority, and Google almost always comes up tops—and, as you know all too well, Live Search and Yahoo! seem perennially locked in a fight for #2.

But slowly and quietly, Yahoo! is making improvements to its search engine, and that has not gone unnoticed in the Webosphere. The new Yahoo! Search incorporates some slick features which bestow upon Yahoo! no bragging rights.

Changes include the Search Assist tool, a space that shows up below the search field and suggests keywords as you type in your query. Then there's integration of the user's query with Flickr photo tags on the search results page, audio snippets when a music band or song name is searched for, and the inclusion of inline video elements on the search results page.

No-one is very impressed, because even if it's cool, it's been done before. Google has had the blended search option for a

while now. The Search Assist tool is a clone of Spotlight in AOL Search and of Google Suggest, and Ask.com's Smart Box features.

One thing must, however, be said: in a recent test conducted by Web analysis firm Compete, Yahoo!'s search query replies generated more clicks than Google's or Microsoft's. Now how many competitors are there to Compete, we don't know, so...

The company says more improvements are in the pipeline. We'll look forward to them.

SOON UP FOR GRABS

.Asia Domains—Finally

The Internet Corporation for Assigned Names and Numbers (ICANN) recently approved a proposal for

creating .asia as a top level domain name by 6 December 2007.

Currently, registration for that domain is limited to businesses that can prove they are functioning in the Asia-Pacific region. Registration can be done from the 90-odd authorised registrars in the region till 15 January 2008. After that, businesses can register without the need to prove that they operate from the region. Public registration will begin by February, 2008.

It has been well planned out. Registration being limited to *bona fide* businesses running out of the region thwarts the menace of cyber-squatting—buying a popular-sounding domain to sell it later at a higher price. The ICANN has decided to continue with the practice of verifying the business industry a buyer belongs to before registration of a site. All .asia domain registrations will be overseen by the non-profit DotAsia Foundation.

According to research conducted by the ICANN, 11

percent of all domain name registrations occur from the Asia-Pacific region despite the region having an online population of 33 per cent of all Internet users. The Web arrived in Asia much later than in the West; popular .com and .net domain names had already been taken by North American and EU users, therefore the push for a .asia domain. Moreover, it gives a geo-specific flavour to businesses. It is interesting to note that .eu is the only other regional, non-nation-specific TLD.

FOR KERALA STUDENTS...

Free Software Becomes Compulsory

The Director of Public Instruction for Education in Kerala has issued an order informing all schools in